# Ratzanyel Rincón

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Canada

November, 2026
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## Education

**University of British Columbia (UBC)** 2021-2027 (expected)
Ph.D. Candidate in Economics

**El Colegio de México, A.C. (Colmex)** 2016-2018
M.A. in Economics

**Instituto Politécnico Nacional (IPN)** 2011-2015
B.S. in Physics and Mathematics

## Professional Experience

**Banco de México** 2018-2021
Economist, Directorate General of Economic Research

## Fields of Research

Labour Economics, Applied Econometrics

## Job Market Paper

Suppressing Paper Unions: Evidence from the USMCA's Labour Provisions in Mexico
*with Ángel Espinoza and León Fernández Bujanda* [Paper]

**Abstract**: We study the effects of a major labour reform induced by the U.S.–Mexico–Canada Trade Agreement (USMCA) on Mexico's union system, which aimed to improve workers' wages and working conditions by eliminating *paper unions*—unions that exist only on paper, do not represent workers, and allow firms to forestall real unionization. The reform required existing collective bargaining agreements (CBAs) to be legitimized by workers through secret-ballot votes and introduced stricter requirements for signing new CBAs. As a result, 78% of pre-reform CBAs were terminated, with few new CBAs created subsequently. We combine the universe of pre-reform CBAs with matched employer–employee and survey data and employ a matched difference-in-differences design to estimate the effects on union firms. We find that the reform had a null effect on average wages, but employment and the wage bill at union firms increased by 3.6% and 3.1%, respectively, by 2026. Profits at union establishments in manufacturing also increased by 5.4% following the reform. To rationalize these findings, we develop a model of optimal firm sorting in which the reform reduces firms' marginal labour costs by eliminating payments to paper unions and weakens the union threat by raising the cost of unionization for workers.

## Working Papers

Are Immigrants Particularly Entrepreneurial? Firm Ownership as a Key Element in Immigrant Income Assimilation
*with David A. Green, Huju Liu, Yuri Ostrovsky, and Garnett Picot* [Paper]

Causal Inference with Groupwise Matching
*with Kevin Song* [Paper]

Working Income Tax Benefits, Minimum Wage, and Employment Transitions of Low-Skilled Workers: Evidence From Canada [Paper]

## Work in Progress

Inside the Collective Agreement: Text, Linked Microdata, and the Economics of Union Bargaining
*with Pierre-Loup Beauregard and João Galindo da Fonseca*

## Publications

Quarterly Multidimensional Poverty in Mexico Using Machine Learning Algorithms. *Estudios Económicos*, Vol. 38, No. 1, January, 2023, pp. 3-68. [Paper]

## Grants and Awards

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| Stone Centre on Wealth and Income Inequality Ph.D. Fellowship, UBC | 2024-present |
| Four Year Doctoral Fellowship, UBC | 2022-2026 |
| Center for Innovative Data in Economics, Research Grant, UBC | 2024 |
| Graduate Studies Fellowship, CONACyT Mexico | 2016-2018 |
| BBVA Academic Excellence Award, Colmex | 2016 and 2017 |
| Academic Excellence Award, IPN | 2014 and 2015 |

## Presentations

"The Effects of Suppressing Company Unions: Evidence from Mexico" presented at the 30th Annual Latin American and Caribbean Economic Association Meeting (November 2025)

"Quarterly Multidimensional Poverty in Mexico Using Machine Learning Algorithms" presented at PUED UNAM's seminar (June 2024) and the 24th Annual Latin American and Caribbean Economic Association Meeting (November 2019)

## Research and Teaching Experience

**Research Assistant to:**

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| Prof. David Green, University of British Columbia | Fall 2023-present |
| Prof. Kevin Song, University of British Columbia | Spring 2023 |
| Prof. Jaume García, Pompeu Fabra University | Summer 2017 |

**Teaching Assistant:** Introduction to Econometrics I (B.A. course, UBC). Econometric Methods (M.A. course, UBC). Mathematics for Economics (M.A. course, UBC). Statistics (M.A. course, Colmex). Game Theory (B.A. course, Colmex). Mathematics II (B.A. course, Colmex)

## Language, Programming Skills, and Other

Spanish (native), English (fluent)
Proficient with R, Stata and Julia
Ph.D. Student Representative at Vancouver School of Economics, UBC 2024-2025
Volunteer at *Tutor en Internet MX* and *Aplicar Desde México*

## References

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